The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: January 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

January 2026 Locked January 2026 is locked (closed 3 Feb 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 41.9% gross margin in January: maintenance contracts the most (63.8%), installations the least (32.0%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

January's jobs made $76,716 gross margin (41.9%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $22,372 and overheads $58,730, leaving ($4,386) profit before tax ((2.4%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 44.2% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$76,716
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$49,980
Technician time not charged to jobs	$22,372
Gross profit (the P&L)	$54,344
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$58,730
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($4,386)
Revenue	$183,306
Gross margin on jobs, %	41.9%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(2.4%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**44.2%**

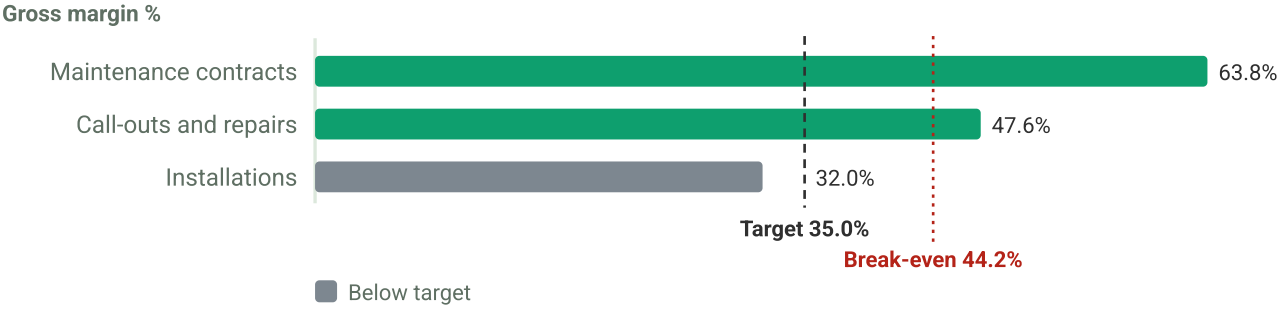
Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, January · All jobs
41.9%
target 35.0%

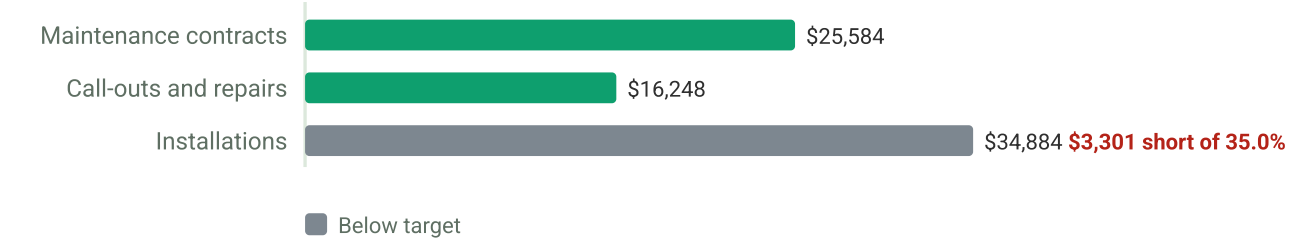
Job gross margin, December · All jobs
43.7%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
44.2%
covers overheads and time not charged (January)

Job gross margin by type of job, January 2026



Gross margin $



What it shows

In January maintenance contracts made a 63.8% job gross margin, installations made a 32.0% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 47.6% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 44.2% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 32.0% gross margin, 3.0 points under the 35.0% target: about $3,301 on $109,100 of revenue in January. It's below the 44.2% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in January).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

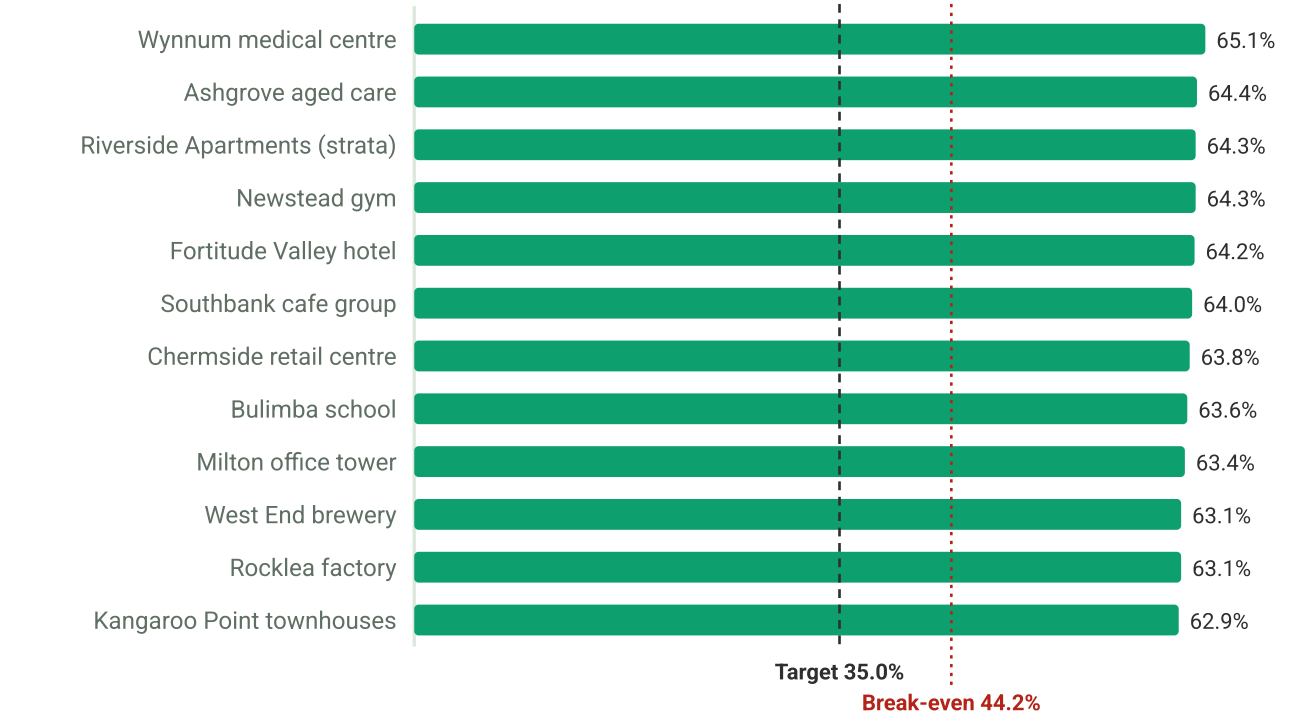
Job gross margin, January · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, December · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

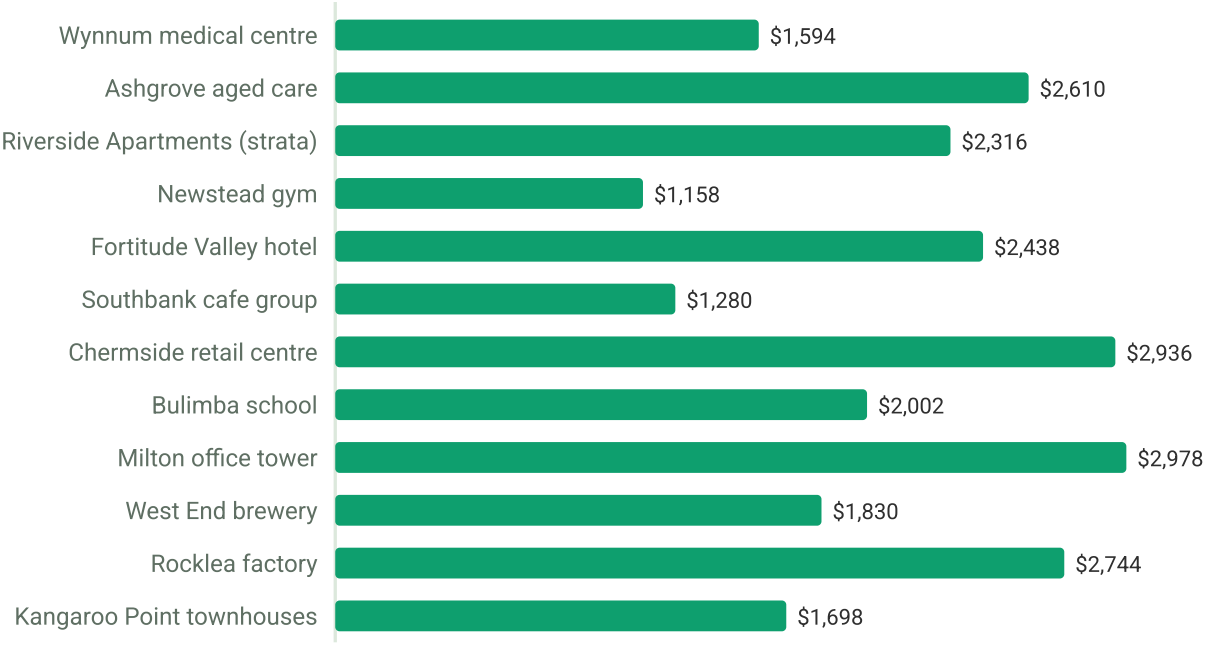
Gross margin jobs need to break even
44.2%
covers overheads and time not charged (January)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in January). All maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in January).

Type of job: Installations

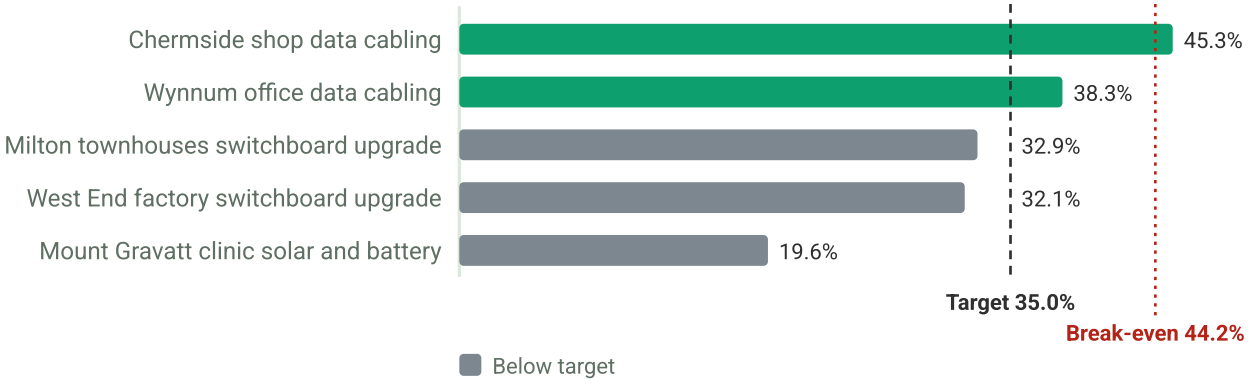
Job gross margin, January · Installations
32.0%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, December · Installations
31.6%
target 35.0%

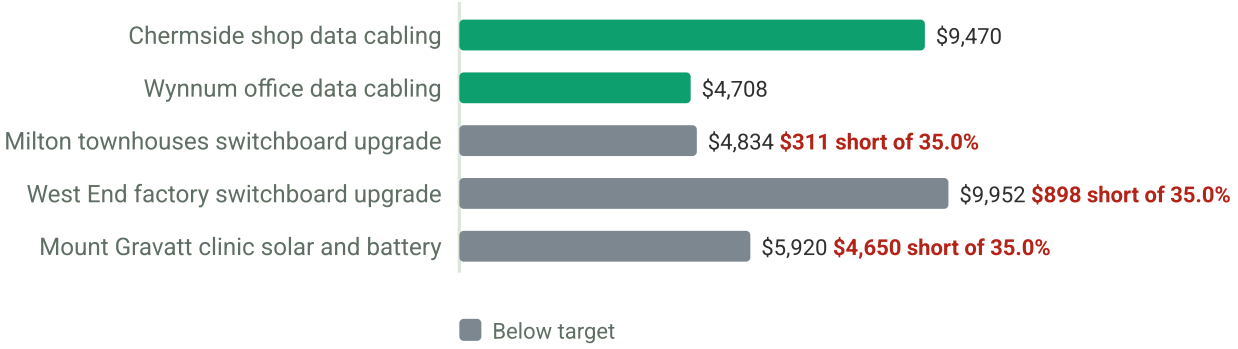
Gross margin jobs need to break even
44.2%
covers overheads and time not charged (January)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

3 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in January made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Mount Gravatt clinic solar and battery made a 19.6% job gross margin: 110.0 h of technician time ($7,480) and $3,000 of subcontractors on a $30,200 job. Jobs need 44.2% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

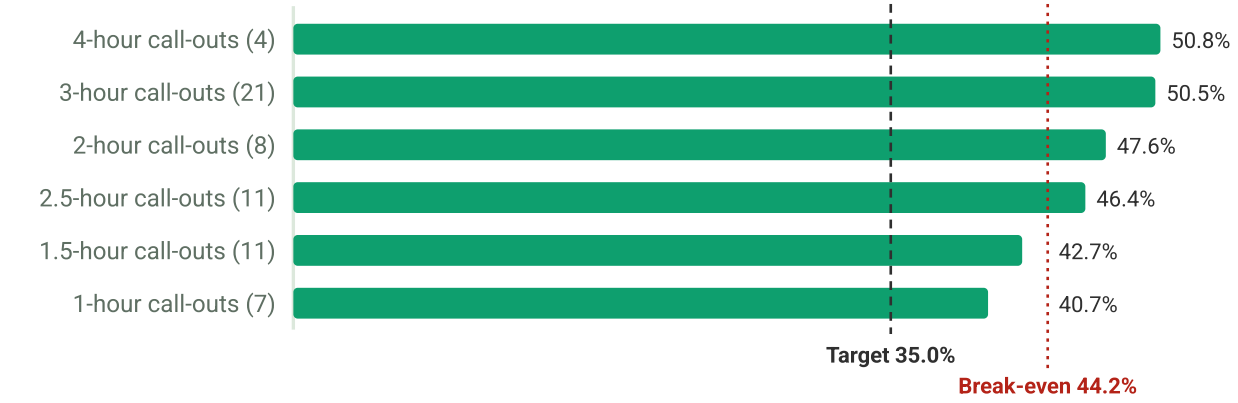
3 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about $5,859 between them on $75,900 of revenue. The biggest gap, Mount Gravatt clinic solar and battery: 19.6% gross margin, 15.4 points under the 35.0% target: about $4,650 on $30,200 of revenue in January. It's below the 44.2% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

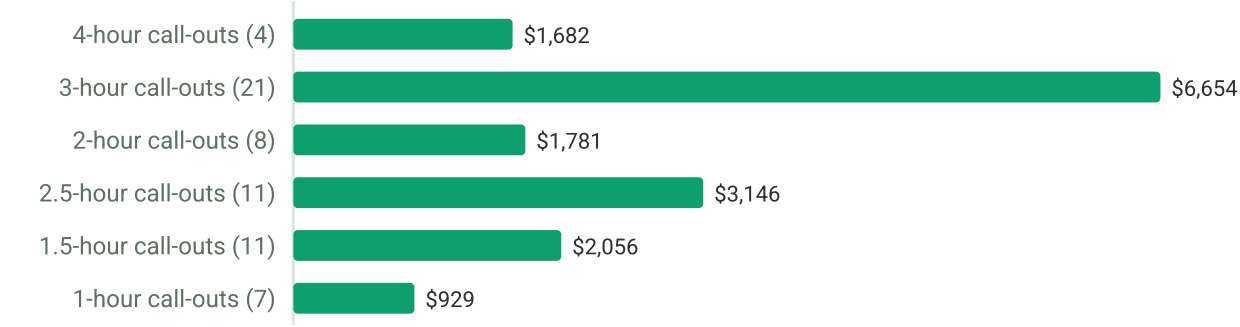
Job gross margin, January · Call-outs and repairs	Job gross margin, December · Call-outs and repairs	Gross margin jobs need to break even	Technician time charged, January	Materials charged, January
47.6%	**47.9%**	**44.2%**	**$23,797**	**$10,309**
target 35.0%	target 35.0%	covers overheads and time not charged (January)	69.8% of call-out revenue	$7,930 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

62 call-outs in January billed $23,797 of technician time and $10,309 of materials ($7,930 at cost plus 30%), and made a 47.6% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 40.7% to 50.8% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

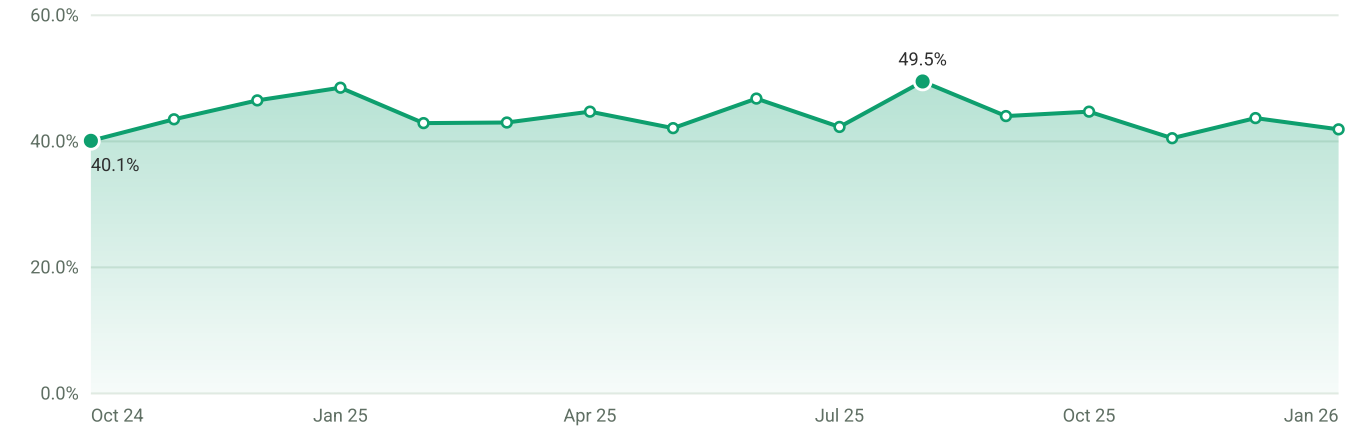
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 47.6% gross margin, 12.6 points over the 35.0% target ($4,311 ahead on $34,106 in January).

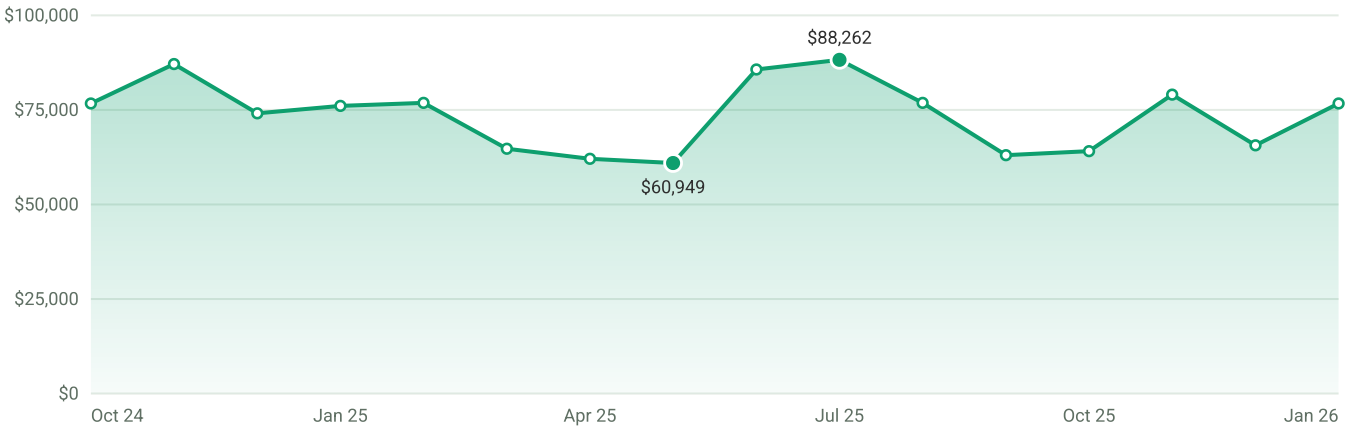
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.